

than 500,000 residents—just 50 years later, 23 European cities had passed that landmark, and nine had more than a million inhabitants: London, Paris, Berlin, Vienna, St. Petersburg, Manchester, Birmingham, Moscow, and Glasgow. However, despite this massive increase in city living, at the turn of the 20th century, the majority of people—even in industrialized nations—still lived in the country.

Squalor, space, and sanitation

For those who were forced to move to the cities, life was often squalid and miserable. In the first half of the 19th century, the influx of people to the cities outstripped the facilities available, which meant that in some poor urban areas, food supply and sanitation were so bad that the high mortality rate (both from malnutrition and from diseases caused by overcrowding, such as cholera and typhoid) kept urban growth relatively slow. Indeed, not all cities experienced continuous growth—

some even declined. Water was polluted with human filth, the air with industrial pollution, and rats and insects quickly spread disease. Not surprisingly, the situation was worst in the world's most populous cities, such as London, Paris, Constantinople, and particularly Peking (now Beijing), which in 1800 was the only city with more than a million inhabitants.

The appalling conditions in the working-class slums close to his father's cotton mill in Manchester, in northern England, inspired German philosopher Friedrich Engels to write *The Condition of the English Working Class in 1844*. It impressed the political philosopher Karl Marx (see pp.334–35), and provided valuable information for the socialist movement (see pp.336–37). It also added to the demands for improved health and sanitation in city slums. Such developments meant that urban populations began to expand naturally, rather than as a result of rural immigration, prompting the expansion that took place between 1850 and World War I.

Urban planners also came to realize that space was as important to health as sanitation. One result of this was the provision of “green lungs”—city parks

INVENTION

UNDERGROUND RAILROADS

In many of the world's cities, underground railroads are referred to as the “Metro,” after the world's first example: the Metropolitan Railway in London (now part of the Metropolitan Line), which opened with steam traction on January 10, 1863. Putting the railroad underground by cutting or boring a tunnel was a means of providing rapid, frequent, and cheap transportation around a crowded city. Continental Europe's first underground railroad was the Tünel, opened in Istanbul in 1875, though it only covered 1,880 ft (573 m). The first subway in the US opened in Boston in 1897.



aimed at improving people's health and comfort—and another was the emergence of model towns. While industrialists are often characterized as exploiting the masses, many were philanthropists. In 1786, Scottish cotton magnate David Dale built the model town of New Lanark (see pp.336–37) for his workers, and his example was followed by several other industrialists during the 19th century, including his son-in-law, Robert Owen. In 1898,

Sir Ebenezer Howard published *Tomorrow: the Peaceful Path to Real Reform*, in which he outlined his vision of the “Garden City,” an idealized town incorporating extensive green spaces. This was a great influence on 20th-century urban planning. >>

Manhattan, New York

Elevated railroads, such as this one in Manhattan, photographed in 1895, allowed expanding cities to accommodate multiple modes of transportation.

1.7 MILLION The number of people living in Chicago in 1900. The population more than tripled in the 50-year period from 1850 to 1900.

